UCR Course Design Resources

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Accessibility and Inclusive Course Design

As of April 24, 2024, the Department of Justice has decided that the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA), which covers the grounds of digital inclusivity, extends to public higher education institutions, requiring that web content adhere to Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) 2.1, level AA standards. This includes content contained within Learning Management Systems.

- Fact Sheet
- Full Ruling (PDFâ¤“)

The ruling defines a targeted compliance date of April 24, 2026 for institutions the size of UCR.

To help you get started revising and remediating your course content, XCITE, in partnership with campus leadership, has put together an Accessibility Guidance for Faculty webpage. Visit it for information about different aspects of your course relevant to accessibility.

If you need support in remediation your course content, please submit a request to the XCITE Accessibility Team (A-Team).

For guidance or support around UCR's accessibility policies, campus community members can seek assistance from the ADA/Section 504 Coordinator at the UCR Office of Civil Rights.

Inclusive Course Design

Contact XCITE to request guidance about accessible course design.

phone: (951)827-2612; email: xcite-help@ucr.edu

Info: Canvas Accessibility Resources

Canvas Resources

- What are the Canvas accessibility standards?
- Canvas Course Accessibility Checklist
- How do I use the Accessibility Checker in the Rich Content Editor as an instructor?
  - See also: Cidi Labs Accessibility and Usability Tools
- Enabling Microsoft Immersive Reader in Canvas

Accommodations and Consultation

Contact UCR's Student Disability Resource Center (SDRC) for help with student accommodations.

phone: (951)827-3861; email: sdrc@ucr.edu

Info: UCR Accessibility Resources for Instructors

From UCR's Student Disability Resource Center

- Faculty, Instructors, & TAs
- Providing Extended Time for Exams in Canvas
- SensusAccess (for conversion of document formats)
- Accessible Design
- Râ€™Ability: Access Information for Students Approved for Disability-Related Accommodations
- Zoom Access Best Practices
- ASL/CART Campus Resources (for requests outside of classroom accommodations)

Note: SensusAccess is a service anyone with a UCR email address can use as a resource (all students, staff, faculty, and alumni)

UCR Inclusive Course Design Rubric Request Form

Please enter your information to access the UCR Inclusive Course Design Rubric. Access this request form, or distribute the link to this form directly through Google Forms (URL: tinyurl.com/UCR-Inclusive-Design).

Introduction:

This rubric seeks to support the intentional development of equitable, diverse, and inclusive higher education courses by individual practitioners as well as course design and delivery teams. This is not an exhaustive rubric but may guide and focus discussion and decision-making around inclusive teaching research and best practices. Many of the suggested guidelines adopt a Universal Design for Learning (UDL) framework and are effective teaching and learning practices in general.

Getting Started:

- The rubric is designed to be used as a whole or in part as individual practitioners and design teams adapt it for specific course or campus needs.
- A notes section is provided to promote implementation through reflection by individual practitioners or discussion between course design and delivery teams.
- The rubric can be applied at different stages of development and delivery and is meant to promote a reflective, collaborative, and iterative course design process.

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* Indicates required question

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